

Data requests

<div class="callout callout-warning"> <div class="callout-header"> <div class="callout-icon-container"> <i class="callout-icon"></i> </div> <div class="callout-title-container"> Disclaimer </div> </div>

<div class="callout-body"> <p> This website is under continuous development. Content may be incomplete or subject to change. </p> <p> The PEH Data Platform User Guidance is provided for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal or regulatory advice. </p> </div> </div>

Data access request

Access to **individual-level data** stored in the **Personal Exposure and Health (PEH) Data Platform** is granted on request and subject to approval.

Who can request access?

Data access requests can be submitted by a **Receiving Data Controller (RDC)** for research projects in the public interest, in line with the objectives of the PEH Data Platform.

If multiple RDCs are involved in the same research project, and they require **different subsets of data**, **each RDC must submit a separate request**, specifying: - their own research questions, and - the specific data requested.

Data access procedure

Step-by-step

1. The RDC submits a **Data Access Request Form**
 - Via [Microsoft Forms](#).
 - To prepare for a form submission, you may consult the corresponding word version [here](#).
 - Provides the required annexes as instructed in the form.
 - Selection of **studies**:
 - Selection of **variables**:
2. The request is reviewed by the **Data Request Access Committee (DRAC)**, including a data minimisation check.

The original data providers (**Supplying Data Controllers – SDCs**) may object to the request.
3. If approved, access is granted:
 - to the requested subset of PEH data (studies and variables),
 - filtered to studies for which no SDC objection was raised, and
 - **only after signature of the Protocol** by the RDC (<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19232226>).
4. Approved data extracts are made available through the PEH Data Platform:
<https://peh.vito.be/>

To avoid requesting data for research questions that have already been explored, it is advised to browse the Publications section in this user guide prior to submitting your request.

Information required in the Data Access Request Form

The Data Access Request Form collects the following information.

1. Project identification

- Main project name (acronym and full name)
- Research project title
- Date of submission

2. Scientific context

- Scientific background
- Objective and specific research questions

3. Methods

- Study design
- Target population
(*e.g. age groups, sex, inclusion/exclusion criteria*)

4. Requested data

- Requested datasets and studies
- Requested variables

Requested data **must be specified using the official annex files** generated via this application.

5. Data analysis plan

- Statistical methods and analytical models
- Sensitivity or pooled analyses (if applicable)
- Requirements for data comparability

6. Data minimisation

- Explicit declaration that only data strictly necessary to answer the research questions are requested

7. Administrative information

- Responsible person and institution
- Contact details
- Data analysts and (if applicable) external data processors
- Planned study start and end dates
- Publication intentions

Required annex files (generated via this app)

To complete a Data Access Request, **two annex files are required**. Both must be **downloaded from this application**.

Annex – Studies

Download the **Annex – Studies** file(s) from [Studies](#).

For each study you request: - set **request_stud_1isYes = 1**

All studies marked with **request_stud_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Annex – Variables

Download the **Annex – Variables** file(s) from the [Codebooks](#)

For each variable you request: - set **request_var_1isYes = 1**

All variables marked with **request_var_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Only annex files **generated and completed via the Studies and Codebooks sections of this application** are accepted.

Questions?

For questions regarding data availability or the data access procedure, please contact:
PEHDataPlatform@vito.be